BRAINSTORMING

Date	
Team ID	N/A - Individual Project
Project Name	ServiceNow-Based Employee Laptop Request Application
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Purpose of the Ideation Phase

The ideation phase is used to understand the problem, explore possible solutions, and select a practical idea for development. As this is an individual project, the brainstorming is documented as an individual exercise: potential features are listed, related ideas are grouped, and priorities are selected according to their importance and feasibility.

Step 1: Problem Identification and Statement Formulation

Background and Problem Context

Employees may need to request laptops through emails, informal communication, or other manual processes. When the request and approval process is not centralized, employees may have to follow up with managers, approvers may not receive timely reminders, and the status of a request may not be easy to identify. Maintaining records and communicating decisions manually can also add administrative effort.

Problem Statement

> **How might we simplify and automate employee laptop requests using ServiceNow so that employees can submit requests through a structured interface, managers can approve or reject them efficiently, and relevant stakeholders receive timely updates with fewer manual follow-ups?**

Challenges Identified

01	**Unstructured submission** Requests may not follow one consistent process or capture all required details.
02	**Approval delays** Managers may need to be contacted repeatedly when approvals are handled manually.
03	**Limited status visibility** Employees may not know whether a request is pending, approved, or rejected.
04	**Manual communication** Sending updates to employees and approvers can require additional effort.
05	**Record and validation issues** Incomplete information or duplicate requests can make request management harder.

Step 2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Possiblesolutionswere generatedaround thefull requestlifecycle,from submitting a request to receiving a decision. The ideas below are grouped by purpose rather than by participant, since this is an individual project.

Request Lifecycle: Where Ideas Fit

1. SUBMIT	2. REVIEW	3. DECIDE	4. INFORM
Request form Mandatory-field validation Automatic request number	Identify manager Create approval record Notify approver	Approve or reject Capture outcome Update request status	Email relevant users Show current status Keep records traceable

Idea Groups

A. Request Submission and Data Quality

Idea	Purpose
Dedicated request form	Provide a structured interface for employees to enter laptop requirements and related information.
Automatic request number	Generate a unique identifier so that users do not have to enter system-generated details manually.
Mandatory-field validation	Check that essential information is supplied before the request is submitted.
Duplicate-request check	Consider a validation rule to reduce duplicate requests where the business policy requires it.

B. Approval and Workflow Automation

Idea	Purpose
Manager-based approval	Route the request to the appropriate manager or approver.
Flow Designer workflow	Trigger the approval process when a new laptop request record is created.
Outcome handling	Handle approval and rejection paths separately so each result leads to the appropriate actions.
Automatic status updates	Update the request record to reflect its current stage and final approval outcome.

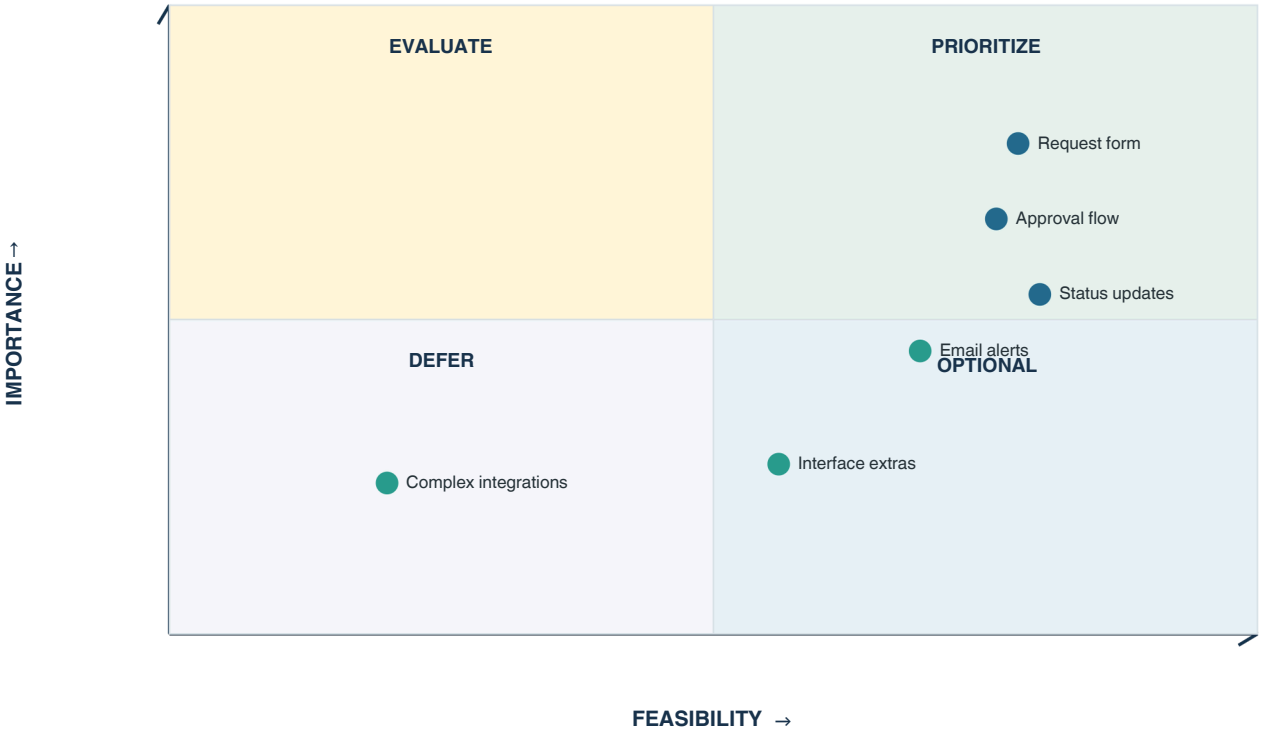
C. Notifications and Request Tracking

Idea	Purpose
Approver notification	Inform the manager when an approval requires attention.
Employee notification	Communicate the approval or rejection decision to the requester.
Centralized records	Keep request details and workflow outcomes in the ServiceNow application.
Status visibility	Make the request's current state easier to identify and follow.

Step 3: Idea Prioritization

Theideas are compared usingtwo criteria. **Importance** measures how directly an idea addresses the identified problem. **Feasibility** considers how practical it is to implement with ServiceNow features, available time, and project scope. The matrix below is an illustrative prioritization for this project.

Importance–Feasibility Matrix



Priority Summary

Priority	Ideas	Reason
1: Core	Request form, manager approval, status updates, essential email notifications	These directly address request submission, decision-making, and communication. They are practical with the selected ServiceNow components.
2: Supporting	Mandatory-field validation, request number generation, duplicate checks	These improve data quality and usability. Their implementation depends on the required platform configuration and business rules.
Evaluate / Defer	Complex external integrations and optional interface enhancements	They may add value but are not essential to demonstrate the primary request and approval workflow.

Selected Idea and Rationale

The selected solution is a ServiceNow-based Employee Laptop Request Application with a dedicated request submission interface, manager approval, automated status updates, and email notifications. It was selected because it addresses the central problem while remaining achievable within the project's scope.

Proposed ServiceNow Components

Record Producer	Provides the user-facing request submission interface.
Custom request table	Stores the submitted laptop request and its fields.
Business Rules	Support server-side validation or request checks where configured.

Flow Designer	Coordinates approval, outcome handling, status updates, and notifications.

Expected Outcomes

• A consistent and structured method for employees to submit laptop requests.

• Less dependence on manual follow-ups during the approval process.

• Clearer status tracking and communication of approval decisions.

• Centralized records that make requests easier to manage and review.
